10 Migration

This chapter covers

- The internals of migration scripts
- Writing custom migrations, including manipulating existing data
- Combining and optimizing migration files
- Dealing with merge conflicts caused by changing a model

Django `Model` objects are proxies to tables in a database, and the migration system helps you maintain the relationship between the two. The migration system is a powerful tool that allows you to move forward and backward through state changes and manipulate data while doing so.

10.1 Migration scripts in detail

In chapter 4, you learned about Django's ORM and how `Model` classes act as a proxy to tables in the database. You used the `makemigrations` and `migrate` commands to push changes down to the database that correspond to the code in your model